It took decades

1876–1920, drawn to scale

1876
Wickham's 70,000 seeds leave Brazil. No law forbids it.

1884
Amazonas puts high export duties on rubber seeds.

28 quiet years

1890s
First commercial rubber plantings in Malaya.

Twenty years after the seeds left, Brazil is still the world's main source of rubber.

1912
Brazil passes the Rubber Defence Law.

1913
Asian plantations overtake the Amazon.

1918
Brazil bans the export of rubber seeds.

1920
Wickham is knighted in Britain.

Timeline · Made for this exhibition